

Credit Application — Questionnaire Flow

Design specification

Owner	Cato Pastoll
Audience	Product design
Purpose	Complete inventory of questions, conditional paths, and document triggers for the credit application UI

1. How to read this document

Every question has an ID. Where a question triggers something, it is listed in the **Triggers** column and specified in full in the section named below.

Notation	Meaning	UI behaviour	Specified in
→ FQ-nn	Reveals a follow-up question	Appears inline, immediately beneath the triggering question, on answer	Section 7
→ DOC-nn	Adds a document to the request list	Not shown inline. Accumulates and appears in Step 5	Section 8
→ DS-n	Escalates a data source from optional to required	Source card in Step 2 changes state	Section 4
→ KO-nn	Knockout — application cannot proceed	Decline screen	Section 3.4
→ CN-n	Consent to be captured	Checkbox	Sections 3.3, 4.3
→ EDD-nn	Enhanced due diligence trigger	No applicant-facing change	Requirements Document, Section 14
→ <i>flag</i>	Sets an internal review flag	No applicant-facing change	—
Pre-filled	Loop already holds this value	Shown populated and editable, with a source indicator	—

2. Flow overview

Step	Name	Applicant sees	Exit
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1	Pre-qualification	11–12 questions, mostly pre-filled	Pass → Step 2 · Fail → decline screen
2	Connect your data	Connect-or-upload cards, completeness meter, consents	Required sources satisfied
3	Questionnaire	7 sub-sections, 18–32 questions depending on path	All required answered
4	Owners	Pre-filled owner list with contact details	All owners confirmed
5	Documents	Consolidated upload checklist	All required uploaded
6	Guarantors (<i>conditional</i>)	Individual consent per guarantor	All guarantors consented
7	Review & submit	Read-only summary	Submitted

Step 6 appears only for some applicants, so the progress indicator must handle a variable number of steps.

Document requests are batched into Step 5 and never surfaced inline. A quiet running counter through Step 3 (“2 documents will be needed”) prevents the surprise at the end.

3. Step 1 — Pre-qualification

Goal: screen out applications that cannot be approved, in under 90 seconds.

Design notes

- Most of this step is confirmation rather than entry. Design it as a review-and-correct experience, not a form. Several questions may reduce to a single card the applicant taps to confirm.
- The whole step reads as “Step 1 of 7”; individual pre-qual questions do not consume visible progress.
- Nothing about documentation requirements is shown until the applicant has qualified.

ID	Question (UI copy)	Input	Validation / helper	Triggers
PQ-1	Where does your business operate from?	Address: street, city, province/state, country, postal code. Pre-filled.	Autocomplete on edit. Not a PO box.	KO-01 · Quebec → French-language flow
PQ-2	What kind of address is this?	Single-select: Commercial office · Retail location · Industrial or warehouse · Home or residential · Co-working space · Virtual office or	Neutral framing — a home address is common and is not disqualifying. Say so.	Home or residential, virtual or mail-forwarding → EDD-02, DOC-17

		mail-forwarding service · Other (+ text)		
PQ-3	What industry are you in?	Searchable single-select, NAICS-mapped. Pre-filled.	Confirm-or-change. Type-ahead must resolve to a listed value.	KO-03 · inventory-intensive → DOC-01 · Retail / Wholesale / E-commerce → FQ-01 · high-risk → EDD-06, DOC-13, DOC-16, DOC-20
PQ-4	Do you operate anywhere outside [country from PQ-1]?	Yes / No	—	Yes → PQ-4a
PQ-4a	Which countries?	Multi-select	Appears only if PQ-4 = Yes	→ DOC-11
PQ-5	When did the business start operating?	Month + Year. Pre-filled where known.	Cannot be in the future	KO-08 · <24 months → <i>full PG</i> , EDD-01, DOC-12, DOC-16, DOC-17, DOC-18 · 24–36 months → <i>limited PG</i>
PQ-6	What was your revenue over the last 12 months?	Single-select band (see 3.1)	Helper: “An estimate is fine — we’ll confirm from your statements.”	KO-07
PQ-7	How much do you expect to spend on the card each month?	Bounded currency input with preset chips	Min and max enforced by the control — an ineligible amount cannot be entered.	→ PQ-7a
PQ-7a	Your credit limit	Derived value, displayed with an edit affordance (see 3.2)	Bounded by the product minimum and maximum	Governing spend ≤ \$50,000 → DOC-05 · > \$50,000 → DS-2 required · > \$150,000 → DS-2 + DS-4 required

PQ-8	Are you authorised to apply for credit on behalf of the business?	Yes / No	If No: capture the correct contact's name and email rather than declining	No → referral flow
PQ-9	Confirm your details	Name, email, phone, role. Pre-filled.	Shown only if PQ-8 = Yes	—
PQ-10	Consent to credit check	Checkbox, required to continue	Shown only if PQ-8 = Yes. Copy in 3.3.	CN-2

3.1 Revenue bands (PQ-6)

- Under \$100,000
- \$100,000 – \$500,000
- \$500,000 – \$1 million
- \$1 million – \$2.5 million
- \$2.5 million – \$5 million
- \$5 million – \$10 million
- \$10 million – \$25 million
- Over \$25 million

Bands are in the applicant's reporting currency, converted for threshold evaluation. The lowest band triggers KO-07.

Note for design: an exact revenue figure is still collected later (Q9), so the minimum enforced there must match this band boundary — **\$100,000**. The band here exists purely to screen quickly.

3.2 Implied credit limit (PQ-7a)

The credit limit is derived, not asked. It is **1.5 × the monthly spend entered at PQ-7**, shown to the applicant immediately and editable.

Copy:

Based on spending around **\$[monthly spend]** a month, we'll look at a limit of **\$[1.5 × monthly spend]**. Need something different? [Request a different limit]

Behaviour

- The derived limit is displayed by default; the applicant does not have to act on it.
- Choosing to override reveals a bounded input, constrained by the product minimum and maximum. An out-of-range amount cannot be entered.
- **An override recalculates the governing spend figure**, which is what every document threshold reads: governing spend is the greater of the monthly spend at PQ-7 and the overridden limit ÷ 1.5. This stops an applicant reaching a higher limit while carrying the documentation burden of a lower one.

- If the override crosses the \$50,000 or \$150,000 threshold, the requirements re-derive immediately and the panel in 3.4 updates before the applicant leaves the step.
- The limit shown here is indicative. Copy must not read as an approval or an offer.

3.3 Consent at the end of pre-qualification (PQ-10)

Placed as the final action of Step 1, immediately before the qualification result.

Copy:

Consent to Credit Check

By checking this box, I authorize [legal entity name] and its service providers to obtain my personal credit report from one or more credit reporting agencies to assess this business loan application. I understand that this will be a soft credit check and will not affect my credit score.

☐ I consent to the soft credit check described above.

The entity name placeholder needs the correct legal name. Note that this text authorises a check on the individual completing the form, who is not necessarily an owner or a prospective guarantor — Legal should confirm that is intended.

3.4 Qualification result

Pass. Show the documentation expectation panel here, not earlier:

What happens next Based on what you’ve told us, you should expect to provide [document summary]. You can save your progress at any point and come back.

Derived from the governing spend thresholds only, so it is deliberately incomplete — copy must say “expect to provide,” not “you will need exactly these.”

Fail. One decline screen with a variable body, not per-reason screens.

ID	Condition	Applicant-facing outcome
KO-01	Country not eligible	Decline: not currently available in that market. Offer waitlist capture.
KO-03	Prohibited industry	Generic decline. Do not name the industry as the reason.
KO-07	Revenue below minimum	Soft decline. Offer to re-apply when they grow.
KO-08	Time in business below minimum	Soft decline, with the date they become eligible.

4. Step 2 — Connect your data

Goal: get verified data in, so answers can be cross-checked.

4.1 Connect or upload

Every source offers two paths, and connection must read as the clearly preferred one. One source (DS-2) is upload-only, so the step copy must not promise a connection for everything.

Element	Treatment
Connect	Primary button. Badge: “Usually takes under 2 minutes.”
<i>Upload documents instead</i>	Secondary, lower-emphasis link. Not hidden — it must never be a dead end — but visibly the second option.
Difference in copy	Connection: “We read the data directly, so there’s nothing to gather and your application moves faster.” Upload: “We’ll need to review these manually, which takes longer.”

Design note. The honest argument for connecting is speed and accuracy, and that argument is strong enough on its own.

ID	Source	Requirement	Connect	Upload alternative
DS-1	Business bank accounts	Required	Aggregator; multiple institutions supported	Bank statements, last 6 months
DS-2	Financial statements	Required if governing spend > \$50,000	Not available — upload only	Accountant-prepared financial statements
DS-3	Payment processors	Optional, but required if Q5 = B2C	Aggregator	Processor statements, last 6 months (DOC-02)
DS-4	Tax agency	Required if governing spend > \$150,000	Direct	T2 for the last year, plus statements of account for RC, RT and RP accounts

Where documents are uploaded, use AI to detect whether the document uploaded is the correct type.

Connection happens in a modal and must return the applicant to this screen with state preserved.

DS-1 is load-bearing. For every applicant below the DS-2 threshold it is the only verification source in the application — bank transaction data is what confirms revenue, cash position, and whether the business is actually profitable. It must stay required for all applicants, and the upload fallback must be treated as a genuine equivalent rather than an afterthought.

Sequencing note. DS-3 becomes required based on Q5, which is not answered until Step 3. Either offer it to everyone here and escalate the card to required later, or accept DOC-02 in Step 5 instead. The applicant must be able to return to this step from Step 3 either way.

4.2 Completeness meter

A progress bar at the top of the step, persisting into Step 3 in compact form.

Copy: “Application strength” or similar, with a supporting line: “Applications with connected data are decided faster.”

Source	Connected	Documents uploaded instead
DS-1 Banking	30%	20%
DS-2 Financial statements	n/a — upload only	25%
DS-3 Payment processors	20%	10%
DS-4 Tax agency	25%	15%

4.3 Consents

Separate checkboxes, each individually actioned. They may not be bundled into a single “I agree” control.

ID	Consent	Given by
CN-1	Access to connected banking, tax, and processor data	Applicant
CN-2	Soft credit check	Applicant — already captured at PQ-10 , not repeated here
CN-3	Collection and use of personal information	Applicant
CN-4	Electronic communications and e-signature	Applicant

CN-2 is listed for completeness only. Guarantor personal credit consent is collected in Step 6, from each individual, only if a guarantee is required.

5. Step 3 — Questionnaire

Seven sub-sections, each a screen or clearly delineated section.

Design notes

- Conditional follow-ups appear **inline, immediately beneath the triggering question**. Do not push them to the end of a section.
- Path length varies from 18 to 32 questions. **Progress must be section-based, not question-based** — a counter reading “14 of 22” that becomes “of 27” is worse than no counter.
- Pre-filled values are editable, with a small indicator of the source. Overrides are flagged internally, never challenged in the UI.
- Every financial field takes a currency selector, defaulted from Q8.
- Defined terms (gross profit, total debt) need an inline definition on tap.

5.1 Section 3A — About your business

ID	Question (UI copy)	Input	Validation / helper	Triggers
Q1	Business or registration number	Text. Pre-filled.	Format-validated by jurisdiction	—
Q2	Website	URL. Pre-filled.	Optional if Q3 answered	Domain <12 months old → EDD-01
Q3	What does your business do?	Long text, 150 char minimum. Pre-filled where held.	Live character counter. Helper: “Tell us what you sell and who buys it.”	<150 chars → FQ-02
Q4	Is your registered address different from where you operate?	Yes / No	Helper naming the operating address captured at PQ-1	Yes → Q4a
Q4 a	What’s the registered address?	Address, autocompleted	Appears only if Q4 = Yes	—

5.2 Section 3B — How you make money

ID	Question (UI copy)	Input	Validation / helper	Triggers
Q5	How do you primarily earn revenue?	Single-select: B2C one-time · B2C subscription · B2B one-time · B2B recurring, not contracted · B2B recurring, contracted · Mixed	—	Any B2C → DS-3 required, or DOC-02 if unconnected · B2C subscription → FQ-06 · any B2B → DOC-03
Q6	What’s the average value of a sale?	Currency + amount	—	—
Q7	What share of your revenue comes from your top 5 customers combined?	Percent 0–100	—	>60% → FQ-08 · >80% → EDD-04, DOC-19

5.3 Section 3C — Financial position

ID	Question (UI copy)	Input	Validation / helper	Triggers
Q8	What currency do you report in?	Single-select	Sets the default for all following amounts	—

Q9	Total revenue, last 12 months	Currency + amount	Must be at least \$100,000 equivalent, and consistent with the band chosen at PQ-6 — prompt a confirmation if not	Credit limit (PQ-7a) ÷ Q9 > 25% → <i>limited PG</i>
Q10	Gross profit margin, last 12 months	Percent	Inline definition of gross profit, plus a “help me work this out” affordance	<25% → FQ-07
Q11	Is the business profitable over the last 12 months?	Yes / No	—	No → <i>full PG</i> , DOC-12, FQ-03, FQ-04, FQ-09
Q12	How much cash does the business have on hand today?	Currency + amount	—	< 1 month of operating expenses → DOC-04
Q13	How even is your revenue across the year?	Single-select: Fairly even · Some seasonality · Highly seasonal	—	Highly seasonal → <i>note for</i> EDD-03

Verification. Nothing in this section is taken at face value. Revenue, margin, profitability and cash position are all checked against bank transaction data from DS-1, and against financial statements where DS-2 applies. Where a verified figure differs materially from what was entered, the verified figure governs and the difference is surfaced to the analyst — it is never challenged in the UI while the applicant is filling the form.

5.4 Section 3D — Debt and obligations

ID	Question (UI copy)	Input	Validation / helper	Triggers
Q14	What’s your total debt outstanding?	Currency + amount	Helper: include loans, lines of credit, capital leases, and shareholder loans. Zero is valid.	>0 → DOC-10 · Q14 ÷ Q9 > 25% → DOC-04
Q15	Is any of that debt currently past due?	Yes / No	Appears only if Q14 > 0	Yes → FQ-11, EDD-03

5.5 Section 3E — Structure

ID	Question (UI copy)	Input	Validation / helper	Triggers
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Q16	Does the business have any parent companies, holding companies, subsidiaries, or entities under common ownership?	Yes / No. Pre-filled where held.	—	Yes → FQ-10, DOC-08
Q16 a	Tell us about each one	Repeating group: entity name · relationship · jurisdiction	Add / remove rows. Appears only if Q16 = Yes.	Nested corporate ownership → EDD-05, DOC-18

5.6 Section 3F — Background

ID	Question (UI copy)	Input	Validation / helper	Triggers
Q17	Is the business involved in any material litigation, judgments, or tax arrears?	Yes / No; if Yes, free text	Neutral framing — make clear a Yes is not automatically disqualifying	Yes → EDD-07, DOC-13

5.7 Section 3G — Your credit request

ID	Question (UI copy)	Input	Validation / helper	Triggers
Q18	Here's what you're applying for	Read-only summary of monthly spend and credit limit from PQ-7 and PQ-7a, with an edit affordance	Editing returns the applicant to the same derived-limit behaviour as 3.2. If an edit crosses a threshold, re-derive the requirements and update the document counter.	Governing spend ≤ \$50,000 → DOC-05 · > \$50,000 → DS-2 required · > \$150,000 → DS-2 + DS-4 required
Q19	What will you use the card for?	Multi-select + optional free text	Inventory · supplier payments · marketing · payroll · travel & expenses · software & subscriptions · equipment · other	—
Q20	Which best describes how you'll pay your card?	Single-select: Pay the balance in full every month · Mixed — some months in full, some partial · Pay the minimum amount owing	Hidden entirely for customers with 6+ months of Loop card history. Neutral framing; no option should read as the “right” answer.	New customers only. Informational — no hard trigger.

6. Step 4 — Owners

A dedicated step. One question, but it carries the most weight in the flow.

ID	Question (UI copy)	Input
OW-1	Who owns 20% or more of the business?	Repeating group, pre-filled from existing records : full name · ownership % · role · country of residence · email · phone

Rules

- Minimum one entry. Combined ownership must not exceed 100%.
- Corporate owners permitted, and reveal a look-through prompt for the individuals behind them.
- Email and phone are required for every individual.
- No individual owner resident in an eligible jurisdiction → *refer to Credit*.
- Nested corporate ownership → EDD-05, DOC-18.

Design notes

- **Pre-fill is what makes this step survivable.** Asked cold it is the highest-abandonment question in the flow: it requests other people's personal information, in an unfamiliar context, often requiring the applicant to go and look things up. Presented as a list to confirm rather than a form to fill, it becomes one of the easiest steps. Design for confirm-and-correct.
- Contact details are required so that guarantee consent in Step 6 can be routed to each individual directly. The copy should say so — it explains why we're asking, and it sets the expectation that those people may hear from us.
- This step needs the most forgiving save-and-resume in the flow.
- Where an owner's details are pre-filled but stale, the applicant editing them should update the underlying record, not just this application.

7. Follow-up question library

ID	Question (UI copy)	Appears when	Input
FQ-01	Where do you store your inventory?	PQ-3 is Retail, Wholesale, or E-commerce	Single-select: Amazon FBA · Shopify fulfilment · Self-storage · Third-party logistics · Hybrid · Dropship — no inventory held · Other (+ text)
FQ-02	Which products or services drive most of your revenue?	Q3 under 150 characters	Long text
FQ-03	How are you currently funding operations?	Q11 = No	Multi-select: Operating cash flow · Owner savings or equity · Venture or angel investment · Friends and family · Bank debt · Shareholder loans · Other (+ text)

FQ-04	How do the owners take compensation?	Q11 = No	Multi-select: Salary · Dividends · Management fees · No compensation currently
FQ-06	What's your average monthly churn rate?	Q5 = B2C subscription	Percent
FQ-07	What's driving your gross margin below 25%?	Q10 < 25%	Long text
FQ-08	If your largest customer significantly reduced their business with you, what's the plan?	Q7 > 60%	Long text
FQ-09	How much cash do you have available to fund the current loss, and how many months does that cover?	Q11 = No	Currency + amount, and integer months
FQ-10	How do the affiliated entities relate to each other, and does money move between them?	Q16 = Yes	Long text
FQ-11	Can you tell us about the debt that's past due?	Q15 = Yes	Long text

Design note. Six of the ten are long text. Each needs a placeholder that models a good answer, and none should carry a minimum character count — an applicant padding an answer produces worse information, not better. Analysts may request clarification once, so the UI needs a state for a second round on a specific answer.

8. Document library

Presented in **Step 5** as a single checklist. Each item is a card: title, one-line reason, accepted formats, upload state.

Suppression rule. Any document already satisfied in Step 2 must not appear here. DS-2 and DS-4 collect financial statements, the T2, and statements of account for applicants above the spend thresholds, so those artifacts must never be requested a second time in Step 5.

ID	Document (UI title)	Why we need it (UI copy)	Triggered by
DOC-01	Inventory listing and aging	To understand what you're holding and how quickly it turns	PQ-3 inventory-intensive
DOC-03	Accounts receivable aging	To see who owes you and how current it is	Q5 = any B2B

DOC-04	Accounts payable aging, plus monthly P&L and balance sheet	To understand your short-term obligations	Q12 < 1 month of operating expenses, or $Q14 \div Q9 > 25\%$
DOC-05	Breakdown of key operating expenses	To understand your cost base	Governing spend $\leq$ \$50,000
DOC-08	Financial statements and intercompany agreements for related entities	To see the full picture across the group	Q16 = Yes
DOC-09	Personal net worth statement, personal tax return, schedule of real estate owned	Required where a personal guarantee is part of the facility	PG required
DOC-10	List of existing loans, with agreements	To understand your existing commitments	Q14 > 0
DOC-11	Revenue breakdown by country	To understand where your revenue originates	PQ-4 = Yes
DOC-12	Financial projections, 12–24 months, monthly	To understand the path to profitability	Q11 = No, or PQ-5 < 24 months
DOC-13	Litigation details and schedule of insurance	To assess any outstanding legal exposure	Q17 = Yes, or PQ-3 high-risk
DOC-16	Permits, licences, and regulatory approvals	Required for your industry	PQ-3 high-risk, or PQ-5 < 24 months
DOC-17	Lease agreements and list of business locations	To confirm where you operate	PQ-2 residential or virtual, or PQ-5 < 24 months
DOC-18	Cap table, org chart, and management biographies	To understand your ownership and who runs the business	Q16a nested ownership, or PQ-5 < 24 months
DOC-19	Contracts for your largest customers	Given the concentration in your revenue base	Q7 > 80%
DOC-20	List of key suppliers and contractors	To understand your supply chain	PQ-3 high-risk

DOC-02 is not requested here — it is the upload alternative on the DS-3 card in Step 2.

Note on DOC-09. It is the only document here with no question naming it. Its trigger is the personal guarantee outcome, which is derived by the credit rules rather than asked — the inputs that set a PG flag are PQ-5 (time in business), Q9 (leverage against the credit limit), and Q11 (profitability). The designer should treat DOC-09 as a card that may or may not appear, decided after Step 3 rather than during it.

Volume control. No application may request more than **6 document types** in Step 5; where the rules produce more, Credit selects what to drop before the list is shown. Design for a maximum of 6 cards and a realistic median of 2 to 3.

9. States to cover

State	Where
Empty, focused, filled, error, disabled	All fields
Pre-filled from Loop records, with source indicator and override	PQ-1, PQ-3, PQ-5, PQ-9, Q1, Q2, Q3, Q16, OW-1
Pre-fill unavailable — blank variant	Every pre-filled field, for any applicant Loop does not already hold data on
Derived value shown, not yet overridden	PQ-7a
Derived value overridden by the applicant	PQ-7a, Q18
Requirements re-derived mid-application after a threshold crossing	PQ-7a, Q18
Conditional reveal and retraction (<i>answer changed; the follow-up's answer is discarded</i>)	All FQ-nn, PQ-4a, Q4a, Q15, Q16a
Connect, connecting, connected, failed, expired	Step 2 cards
Upload-instead path, per source	Step 2 cards
Upload-only source, with no connect affordance	DS-2 card
Source escalated from optional to required mid-application	DS-3 after Q5, DS-2 and DS-4 after a change at Q18
Completeness meter at 0%, partial, and full	Steps 2–3
Document counter incrementing during Step 3	Step 3
Save and resume, including on a different device	All steps
Application expired after 30 days inactive	Steps 1–5
Analyst requests more information after submission	Post-submission
Decline	Step 1
Referral — applicant is not the authorised signer	PQ-8
Owner details stale and corrected by the applicant	Step 4
Quebec applicant, French language	Entire flow